

Start small with separation

If your dog is already reacting strongly to your departure, start small by going through one of the actions that signals departure—like putting on shoes—and then hang out at home. Do this repeatedly to try and remove that initial negative association.

You can then move on to training your dog to sit and stay while moving progressively farther away; train them to lie down when you're out of sight and reward them when you come back.

"Dogs and puppies with this condition need to learn to self-soothe when separated from their guardians. Training will generally start out with low-intensity separation scenarios using gates, pens, and tethers, while the guardian remains at home, with the goal of gradually increasing the intensity over time as a dog or puppy shows that they can handle it," Bassett adds.

Practice low-key departures

When you do leave, don't make a big deal out of it. The same goes for returning home (wait until after your dog settles down and is calm to give affection). It might be tough to pretend you're not overjoyed to see your pup, but it's a good idea to avoid an over-the-top reunion. You want to reinforce the idea that your comings and goings aren't a reason to ramp up energy and emotions.

Exercise is key

Dr. Dodman also recommends "tons of exercise," which generates serotonin, which has a mood-stabilizing, calming effect.

Rodriguez also emphasizes the importance of ample exercise and providing an outlet so your dog is fulfilled and can relax when they need to.

Ultimately, dogs are a lot like humans in that they are complicated and uniquely individual—so there really is no one-size-fits-all approach to separation anxiety. Treating separation anxiety also depends on the severity of the problem. Many experts admit that dealing with extreme separation anxiety can be challenging. "Real separation anxiety is a severe case behavior, and it's a long-term process," says Hodges, who, along with Dr. Dodman, and many other experts, recommends that for very severe cases, you consult your veterinarian for options.

Can Separation Anxiety Be Prevented?

While experts say that it may not always be possible to fully prevent your dog from feeling anxious when you leave the house, there are some ways to help your dog feel safe and calm when you do have to head out.

Create boundaries while you're home

Much like human children, dogs thrive on structure and predictability in their day-to-day routines, so Wood advises organizing your dog's entire day into two categories: interaction and non-interaction. "That means you choose when your dog has a walk, playtime, potty time, cuddle time, training time, or outings...and in all of those moments when you're not deliberately interacting with your dog, they should be crated or relaxing calmly," she says. "This keeps their minds from racing or worrying, and cultivates trust in you."

Bassett agrees that it's important for puppies to experience low-intensity separation from their guardians safely and early on in their lives—in fact, separation from their owner should become part of a puppy's daily routine. "Otherwise, they may be shocked and distressed the first time they are left at home alone, which can activate these behaviors," she says. And, of course, since dogs require a great deal of time and attention, anyone who truly doesn't have the time to properly care for a dog probably shouldn't get one.

It's tempting to give non-stop affection and pets to our dogs when we're home more than usual. And it's adorable when your dog "demands" (with an insistent paw) that you keep petting them. But if that

behavior doesn't have limits, it can lead to bigger problems. "The best thing to do is make sure that that type of behavior from the dog isn't met with play, positive attention or anything that the dog can perceive as rewarding," says Blake Rodriguez, trainer and founder of Dream Come True K9. This means not only taking away that type of attention but also the addition of something that the dog deems as discouraging, like moving them out or off and away from the area. Later on if the dog wants to enter your space they can do so but, in a more respectful and appropriate manner.

Crate training creates space and safety

To avoid encouraging feelings of anxiety in your dog in the first place, many experts tout the importance of crate training for dogs. When done properly, the crate provides a dog a safe, cozy place to relax when you're busy or away, Wood says.

Ideally, crate training is introduced when your dog is a puppy or when they first come home with you. The crate should be used as a haven, and not a punishment. "The reason I'm going to get a crate is that I want a dog to get comfortable in a space that is away from me so that they're not on me 24-7," says Rodriguez. "Because when a dog only knows a life where, when you are around I am on top of you and with you, you run a very high risk of creating separation anxiety."

A crate, however, should never become a substitute for spending time with a dog or puppy, and become a place where they're kept because someone doesn't have the time, energy, or commitment to properly care for them," Woods says. "Isolation is not healthy for a dog," she says.

When you do leave

When you're away, provide some benefits— leave your dog with a safe distraction, like a treat-filled puzzle toy, play music, and make sure there's a comfortable place to rest. When you come home, put away the toys and treats, so they're associated with your being away.

Again, practice low-key goodbyes as a preventative measure. Don't introduce the concept that leaving is a big deal in the first place.

Preventing post-pandemic separation anxiety

It's easy to see the unusual circumstances of the COVID-19 era as a bonanza for dogs. As working from home became the norm, more people adopted dogs who then enjoyed round-the-clock companionship and more walks than even they knew what to do with. It was a win-win for two social species looking for companionship in troubled times. But, if dogs crave routine, what happens when the routine shifts and owners are no longer around 24/7? As Dr. Dodman notes, these shifts are classic triggers for separation anxiety.

Rodriguez told us, "What is likely to happen is a lot of households creating a breeding ground for anxiety. When you have a dog who is with you (and interacting with you) 24/ 7, it might seem fine now. But if you're not setting up your dog where there is playtime, there's engagement time, and then...there is also a bit of separation time, it can create problems."

To give yourself, and your dog, the best chance of avoiding problems down the line, do what you can to maintain that separation time. That doesn't have to mean confining your dog physically with a crate or a separate room. But it does mean, says Rodriguez, setting rules "that say, OK. I want you over here when I'm cooking or watching TV."

Try to maintain some semblance of a normal routine when it comes to leaving your house without your dog. And when you're home, maintain that degree of separation, with the limits set by you. Now is a better time than ever to practice time and place, says Rodriguez. "Where there's time to engage and allow your dog into your personal space and also to practice separation, that's a really good thing."

"Since the cause of separation anxiety is still not fully understood, it's not possible to identify specific measures that will prevent it...but there are ways to maximize your dog's alone-time success," Clarke concludes. Consult a vet and a certified trainer as soon as you notice signs of separation anxiety in

your dog. And remember that whether or not your dog suffers from separation anxiety, training, and sustaining a strong relationship should be an ongoing activity for the life of your dog.

Top Stories

A case study to evaluate a role of Mahatikta Ghrutpaan in management of Vicharchika

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ABSTRACT

Ayurveda is the oldest surviving complete medical system in the world. In Ayurveda system of medicine numbers of drugs /preparation are mentioned. Various herbal drugs and Herbo-mineral act as a rejuvenator for skin. Kushtha is among the wide spread chronic, frequently re-occurring diseases of the skin. In the present era skin diseases are difficult to treat and are of high cosmetic value. In Ayurveda all skin diseases are consider under Kushtha. All the skin diseases in Ayurveda have been discussed under the broad heading of Kushtha, which are further divided in Mahakushtha and Kshudrakushtha. This paper highlights a case study of Vicharchika kushtha treated with Mahatikta ghrutpaan.

Key words:

Kushtha, Mahatikta ghrutpaan, Mahakushtha, Kshudrakushtha

Introduction:

In Ayurveda, almost all skin disease can be taken under generalized term “Kushtha”. Vicharchika is one of the Kshudrakushta having the Lakshanas like Shyava, Kina, Kharasparsha, Parusha, Rukshapidika and Kandu. Vicharchika kushta manifests due to vitiation of Saptadhatus like three Dosha, Twak, Rakta, Mamsa and Lasika. Vicharchika kushta is having involvement of Vata and Kaphadosha having the Lakshanas of individual Doshas, in this article management of Vicharchika kushtha is done with Mahatiktaghrutpaan.

Aim:

To evaluate the efficacy of Mahatikta ghrut in the management of Vicharchika

Objectives:

- Literary study of kushtha
- Literary study of Vicharchika
- Literary study of Mahatikta ghrut

Materials and Methods:

15ml of mahatikta ghrut was given orally with lukewarm water early morning with empty stomach everyday for consecutive 30days.

Case study:

Name of Patient	XYZ
Age	33yrs
Sex	Female
Height	5.2ft
Weight	68yrs
Prakruti	Kafa-pittanubandhi
Lakshan	Itching, redness, burning
Chronicity	Since 12yrs
Intensity of pain	No pain
Hetu	Stale food, Frequent intake of meat
Sadhyasadhyatva	Sadhya
Plan of treatment	15ml of mahatiktaghrut was given to the patient everyday in early morning & empty stomach with warm water.
Pathya	Rock salt, Ghee, Bitter guard, Elephant yam, Plantains, Green gram, Ginger, Boiled vegetables, Buttermilk
Apathya	Chillies, Tamarind, Excess salt, Curd, Paneer, Cheeze, Fermented food, Cold water

Criteria for assessment:

Subjective criteria:-

1. Intensity of itching
2. Intensity of burning

Objective criteria:-

1. Redness
2. Size of patch

Observation:

Characteristics	Before treatment	After treatment
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Itching	+++	Nil
Burning	+++	Nil
Redness	+++	Nil
Size of patch	22cmX 9cm	No patch noted

Discussion:

According to Shabdkalpadruma, Kushtha means which causes Despise and contemptible.

According to Shabdkalpadruma, the word meaning of kitibha is kesa keeta.

In Ashtang hrudayam, kushtha chikitsa adhyay acharya vagbhat has stated that

कुष्ठिनं स्नेहपानेन पूर्व सर्वमुपाचरेत् ।

अ. ह. चि. १९/१

That means in all skin diseases one must give ghrutpaan before starting any treatment.

In charak samhita, kushtha chikitsa adhyay, acharya has stated that

वातोत्तरेषु सर्पिर्वमनं श्लेष्मोत्तरेषु कुष्ठेषु ।

पित्तोत्तरेषु मोक्षो रक्तस्य विरेचनं चाग्रम् ॥

च.चि. ७/९२

That means in vatapradhan kushthas snehapaan, in kapha pradhan kushthas vaman karma, in pitta pradhan kushthas virechan karma followed by raktamokshan should be done.

Acharya charak has explained about Vicharchika kushtha,

(1)It is blackish brown in colour;

(2)It is rough in touch like a scar tissue

(3)It is hard to touch³

Dark patches on skin, dryness of skin, roughness on the patches are the symptoms of Vicharchika kushtha.

Using these two references, Snehpaan was selected as a treatment in present case.

Sharandhar samhita, acharya has described Mahatikta ghrut in madhyam khand.

सप्तछदः प्रतिविषा शम्याकः कटुरोहिणी ।

पाठा मुस्तमुशीरं च त्रिफला पर्पटस्तथा ॥

पटोलनिम्बमन्त्रजिष्ठा पिप्पली पद्मकं शठी ।

चन्दनं धन्वयासश्च विशाले द्वे निशे तथा ॥

मुहुची सारिवे द्वे च मुर्वा वासा शतावरी ।
त्रायन्तीन्द्रयवा यष्टी भुनिम्बश्चाक्षभागिका ॥
घृतं चतुर्गुणं दद्याद् घृतादामलकीरसः ।
द्विगुणः सर्पिश्चात्र जनमष्टगुणं भवेत् ॥
तत्सिद्धं पाययेत् सर्पिर्वीतरक्तेषु सर्वथा ।
कुष्ठानि रक्तपित्तं च रक्तार्शसि च पाण्डुताम् ॥
हृद्रोगमुल्मवीसर्पप्रदरं गण्डमालिकाम् ।
क्षुद्रोगान् ज्वरांश्चैव महातिक्तमिदं जयेत् ॥

शा. सं. म. ख. १/४५-५०

In the falashruti of the mahatikta ghrut acharya has mentioned it is a remedy majorly for kushtha. Upon studying properties of contents of mahatikta ghrut, it was selected for the treatment.

All dravyas in the ghrut are Tikta rasatmak, Madhur vipaki and Ushna viryatmak so they has affinity towards Rasa dhatu and ultimately towards skin.

Conclusion:

—— Skin diseases are long time consuming, easily not curable and require patience to take medication for longer duration. Kushtha roga cannot occur without vitiation of tridoshas.

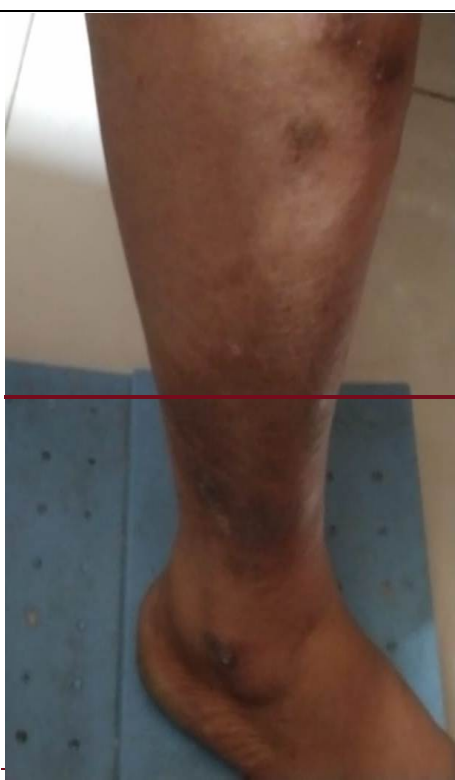
—— Since the disease manifestation starts from the nidana, first line of treatment should be nidana parivarjana. It stops in the further progression of the diseases by restricting the vitiation of doshas.

—— According o Acharya sharangdhara, kushtha roga occurs due to dosha bahulyata. The accumulation kleda results in strotorodha leading to vata vridhhi, because of the combined effect of vata vridhhi and srotovarodha, the rasa dhatu doesnot enter in the srotas. Due to loss of this dravamsha the kleda that remains in twacha will be transferred into ghanibhuta kleda. This results in parushata and khara sparsha of twacha in kitibha.

—— So to pacify vitiated vata dosha ghrut and especially mahatikta ghruta plays an important role.

Results :-

Positive results were seen in the patient during and after the treatment.

		
Before Treatment	During Treatment	After Treatment

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